

Enhancing Walmart's Customer Journey With a Consumer-Centric Store

Embracing digital transformation in the in-store customer journey

Walmart  x 

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Problem

Walmart's unsatisfying in-store customer experience and lack of app integration result in **\$16.2 billion** worth of missed revenue, compromising millions in market shares.

Shopping: Due to price disadvantage and in-store inconvenience, Amazon receives 53% of Walmart's customers within one-day of shopping in-store..

App Integration: 49% of customers do not believe a satisfying customer experience can be delivered in a completely digital way, making digital and physical integration crucial.

Recommendation

Reinventing the in-store customer experience with hybrid omnichannel touchpoints.

#1 In-store experiential display rooms called "ShowPods" embrace showrooming while connecting Walmart's online venues through QR codes.

#2 Virtual iBeacons found in store deliver personalized recommendations based on customer's online preferences and tendencies using the ItemFinder functionality.

#3 The upgraded Walmart app works in tandem with iBeacon enabled Smart Assistants and the experimental "ShowPods."

Outcome

Walmart stores will be the world's leading user-interface hub of customer intelligence, facilitating more personalized and profitable customer experiences.

→ Increased sales, product promotion and localization based on customer buying patterns.

→ Increased market share and frequency of customer visits.

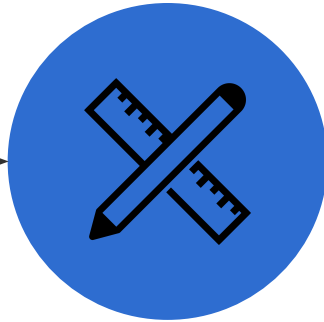
→ Customers can expect the same high degree of personalization both in-store and online.

→ Stores will serve as a forum for customer inspiration and engagement, lining with the company's mission.

Present CUSTOMER JOURNEY

1) ENTRANCE

Customers are greeted with a surplus of disorganized inventory and oversized metal carts.



2) WALK-THROUGH

The current layout prioritizes consistency in the traditional product alignment across all stores, further contributing to the lack of convenience and accessibility.

3) AVAILABILITY

After customers finally locate their desired items, feelings of disappointment arise due to the lack of in-store product availability.

4) EMPLOYEE INTERACTION

The lack of employee engagement increases challenges related to the product knowledge gaps from the store associates.

5) CHECKOUT DELAY

Increasing wait times have become the norm during peak hours. Self-checkout places the burden of labour onto the customer.

STATUS QUO

CHALLENGES

The increasing role of eCommerce and mobile assistance are transforming Walmart's customer experience, prompting customers to seek more ways to feel connected in-store.



Convenience

With eCommerce, customers are demanding more convenience from retailers like Walmart. As Amazon, Uber, Google, and Apple all start converging on their services provided, Walmart is left stuck in the middle.



Experiences

Walmart stores are transactional hubs which do not encourage forging relationships between customers. Advancing from this requires retailers to enhance customer-centricity, digital fluency, and in-store agility.



Personalization

49% of consumers say they will likely become repeat buyers after a personalized shopping experience with a particular company. Walmart needs to look for more ways to strengthen their brand relevance & relationship with customers.

'SCAN-&-COLLECT' SHOWPODS

 The 'ShowPods' are scalable thematic pop-up displays which introduce **online & in-store** SKUs in-store. The exciting and immersive design uses **QR codes** to provide product availability information, delivery, and shipping details via the upgraded Walmart app. By using the "Scan & Go Pod" feature on the app, customers can directly make their purchase, having it delivered to them right away.

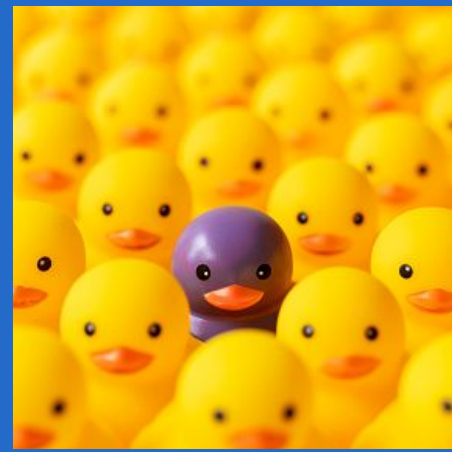
These are some of the possible features the ShowPods will entail.



[QR CODE \(BENEFITS\)](#)

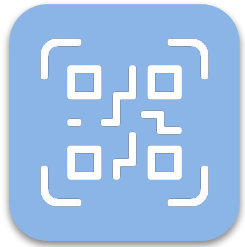


[EXPERIMENTAL RETAIL](#)



["TREASURE HUNTING" & LOCATION](#)

CUSTOMER PERSPECTIVE



QR-CODE

By scanning the QR codes, customers can immediately access catalogues of exclusive items not yet in store.



PODLISTS

Customers can easily save and purchase items by adding them to their "PodList."



PROMOTIONS

Seasonal promotions and sales will be applied to the exclusive items.



DEMOS

Live demos & DIY workshops will take place in the ShowPods as a way to strengthen community building & authenticity.



DISCOVER PODS

Based on patterns from the "wish list," the app generates a map of similar ShowPods in different Walmart locations that the customer might like

ADVANTAGES



INCREASES RETENTION RATES

An extended online catalogue encourages customers to purchase instantly on-spot as [54%](#) of customers are likely to view a product in store and buy online at home.



BOOSTING CUSTOMER LOYALTY

Amazon received [57%](#) of business from people who “showroomed.” By streamlining the checkout process via the PodList, the likelihood for customers to switch to other eCommerce platforms is significantly reduced.



PROMOTES COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

[31%](#) of customers prefer feeling in a community when they shop, and [70%](#) of Europeans believe malls reflect local communities. By cultivating a sense of uniqueness in Walmart stores, customers feel more inclined to shop there.

[ShowPods Benefits](#)



#2 | Recommendation

VIRTUAL iBEACONS



OPPORTUNITY

As Walmart collects [2.5](#) PB every hour of unstructured data from [1 million](#) customers, leveraging Walmart's Big Data helps optimize shopping experiences for customers wherever they are.

WHAT ARE VIRTUAL BEACONS (vBLE)?

Walmart can utilize virtual iBeacons to make *personalized* product recommendations for customers, developing their "hands-free" experience. Originally made for the iOS operating system using Bluetooth 4.0 technology, it is compatible with all smartphones equipped with a Bluetooth chip.

Today, most smartphones and tablets are BLE (Bluetooth Low Energy) compatible, meaning they can seamlessly communicate with Bluetooth-enabled devices. As more than [83%](#) of the population uses a mobile phone, iBeacons are an effective way to send ShowPod notifications & product recommendations to the phones of customers entering the store while seamlessly collecting location data.



[Use cases](#)

iBEACON PROCESS/COMPONENTS



GEOFENCING

Walmart's geofencing technology detects when customers enter/exit the store. Paired with a geofenced notification, location data substantially increases customer visits as [55%](#) of shoppers visit a retailer after receiving location-based messages.



WALMART & I SURVEY

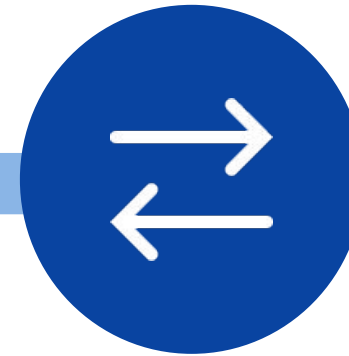
After entering the store, customers will be greeted with an on-site notification on their mobile device, taking them to the **Walmart & I** survey. Proprietary data will be collected through a *10-question* survey to collect individual-level data, helping customers achieve their shopping goals.



ITEM FINDER

After completing the survey, time-pressed customers are able to use the "Item Finder," which uses the Map feature on the Walmart app to identify certain wants within the store layout.

[Opportunity](#)



BIG DATA

Walmart's Big Data pairs with the iBeacons with the collected results from the survey data to identify shoppers current preferences & motivations, giving personalized roll back deals, promotions, and custom preferences based on their data profile.



VIRTUAL BLE iBEACONS

With virtual iBeacon enabled technology added to pre-existing Wi-Fi networks, retailers can communicate & engage proactively with customers in-store or near store premises. By using customer data found on the Walmart App, it enhances personalization.



#2 | Recommendation .

ADVANTAGES

BLE technology, when combined with GPS, Walmart's geofencing, and arrival alerts, can provide location-based experiences indoors without the need for physical installation. The use of Wi-Fi & machine learning allows for easy deployment. A fast, seamless & foolproof way to bridge the gap between marketers & customers provides real-time locational-wear & personalized messages with an easy set-up.



ACHIEVES CUSTOMER GOALS

Organizations that focus their personalized messaging around helping consumers can expect [16%](#) more impact on the likelihood of driving sales compared without.



PROLONG CUSTOMER LIFETIME VALUE

[60%](#) of customers say they will likely become repeat buyers after a personalized shopping experience that increases purchasing confidence.



DRIVES REVENUE

Personalization drives revenue up by [10-15%](#); the more skillful a company is at applying data in-store, the greater the returns.

[Installation](#)

UPGRADED APP

OPPORTUNITY



Of the [230 million](#) customers who visited Walmart weekly in 2022, [less than half](#) were active on the app due to a lack of personalization with the in-store journey.



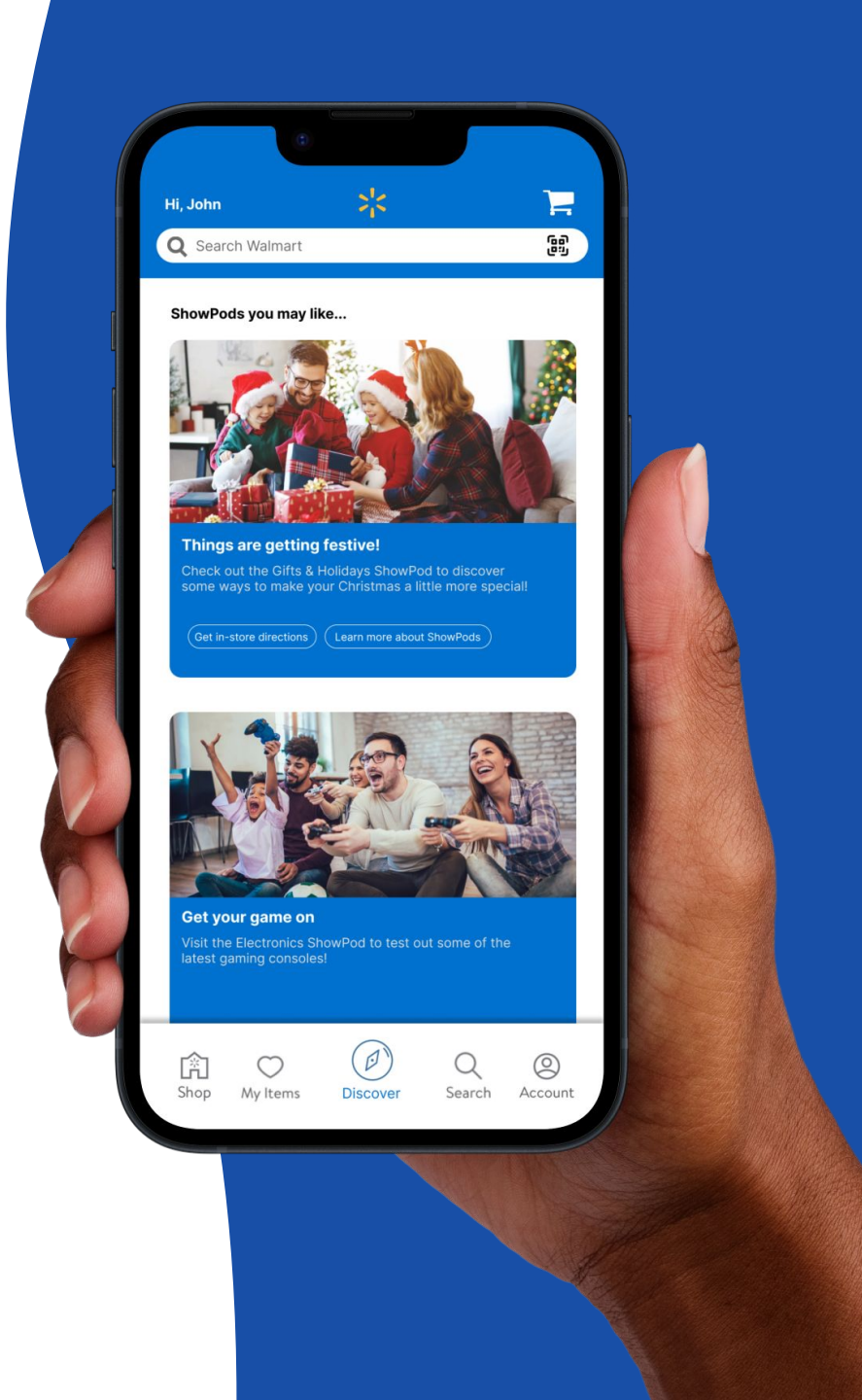
WALMART & I SURVEY

The survey feature of the app leverages data from proprietary questions, driving up the potential value of analytics to [\\$1 million](#) for every [\\$1 billion](#) in retail sales and also adhering to the [44%](#) of global customers who have motivations beyond price and quality.

OUR PROPOSAL

An updated Walmart App will act as the bridge between Walmart's physical & digital channels, allowing customers to interact with the experimental ShowPods and virtual iBeacons.

[Try out the app here!](#)



#3 | Recommendation

UPGRADED APP



DISCOVER PODS

Have new & relevant ShowPods recommended to you.



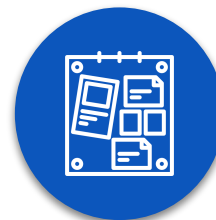
MAP

In-app store map that shows ShowPod and product locations.



“BRING IT TO ME”

Request an associate to bring devices like laptops, which are held in the back, directly to you.



PODLIST

Checkout items or save them for later seamlessly by adding them to a PodList.

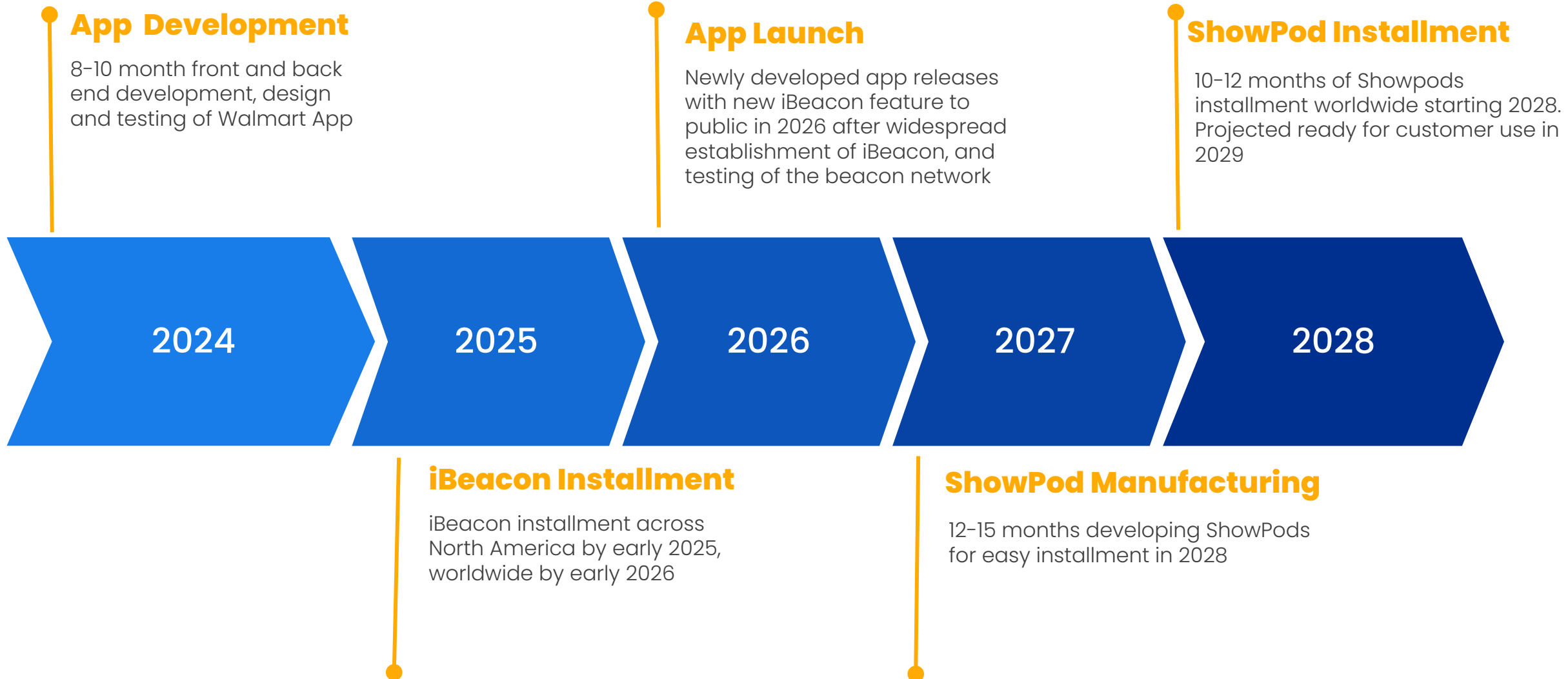


ASSISTANCE

Receive notifications that recommend products you might like based on promotions & past purchases.

Overview

IMPLEMENTATION TIMELINE



The New CUSTOMER JOURNEY

1) Walmart APP

Customers are greeted with promotional messages sent through the Walmart App. New customers will receive an option on their device to set up additional features on the app.

3) RECOMMENDATIONS

Personalized product recommendations and deals are sent to customers through the app based on their survey data and online and in-store purchase history.

5) DELIVERY

Customers can access products through QR Codes in the ShowPods, purchasing or saving them for later in their PodList.



2) SHOWPODS

ShowPods are available throughout the stores, allowing customers to discover & interact with promotional products available online and in-store with a seamless “click-and-collect” transaction.

4) CUSTOMER SERVICE

Employees or third party merchants/manufacturers can aid and offer their product expertise in the ShowPods to customers virtually or physically.

Meet the Team

THANK YOU WALMART BLUE LABS!



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THIS HAS BEEN AN INCREDIBLE EXPERIENCE.

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Overview

APPENDIX

'Scan-&-Collect' ShowPods

[Components](#)

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Virtual iBeacon Personalization

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What Experts Have to Say

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